ODIA PRIDE AT ITS PEAK



Riding on the anti-incumbency factor and Prime Minister Narendra Modi's popularity, the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) won the Assembly polls in Odisha last year with a sound majority. 'Odia Asmita' was one of the party's major poll planks. 'Odia Asmita' refers to the collective pride, identity and cultural heritage of the Odia-speaking people. It encompasses the Odia language, literature, art, history and traditions that define the essence of Odisha and its people.

After Mohan Charan Majhi was chosen as the Chief Minister, his government undertook several initiatives to promote and preserve this cultural identity. On the line of PM Modi's vision of 'Vikash Bhi Virasat Bhi', the government is striving for progress and ensuring at the same time that Odisha's unique identity is recognised and strengthened in the modern world. It has coined a slogan "Odisha, where tradition meets tomorrow" for the purpose.

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Establishment of 'Odia Asmita Bhawan' is one of the such key initiatives. The Bhawan will be a dedicated cultural hub aiming to serve as a centre for the promotion and preservation of Odia language, literature and heritage. It will host various cultural activities, exhibitions and events that celebrate Odia culture.

The second major step the Majhi government in this regard is setting up of an 'Odia Translation Academy' to facilitate the translation of Odia literature into other languages and vice versa. This institution will work towards making Odia literature more accessible to the global audience and promote cross-cultural exchanges.

Development of a 'Paika Rebellion Memorial' is yet another initiative of the government which is certain to pep up the Odia pride as 'Paika rebellion' is considered as the "first war of Independence" but has failed find any such place in the history books.

The government has also created a Rs 200-crore corpus fund to support various cultural initiatives aimed at revitalising Odia identity. The interest generated from this fund will finance not only the above three projects but also to create a 'palm leaf manuscript museum'.

The government has also decided to restructure and reconstitute key cultural institutions such as the Odia Sahitya Akademi, Odia Sangeet Natak Akademi and Lalit Kala Akademi. These academies will be revitalised to enhance their capacity to promote Odia literature, music, dance and arts. Financial assistance is also provided for training in Odissi music and dance. This support aims to preserve and promote the classical dance and music forms that are integral to Odia culture.

Active engagement with the Odia diaspora worldwide is another initiative the Majhi government is trying its hands on. CM Majhi has announced formulation of a policy for 'Pravasi Odias', with focus on increasing their participation in Odisha's development journey and address issues faced by them in their countries.

Promotion of Odia language in official work is another key step the incumbent government has taken to fulfil its election promise of preserving Odia identity. Chief Minister Majhi has mandated the use of the Odia language in all official government work. The move aims to strengthen the presence of Odia in administrative functions and ensure that the language is upheld in governmental processes.

Through the establishment of cultural institutions, revitalisation of historical narratives and active engagement with the public and the Odia diaspora, the Majhi government is fostering a renewed sense of pride and identity among the people of Odisha. These initiatives reflect his government's commitment to cultural preservation and the celebration of Odia heritage in the modern era.



FACTSHEET

TOURISM

- 15 destinations like Puri-Konark, Dhauli, Bhitarkanika, Satkosia, Hirakud-Debrigarh, Talsari, Tampara, Mahendragiri-Jirang, Daringbadi, Deomali-Kolab, the Buddhist Circuit, Chilika & Simlipal identified for integrated development
- Approved under Special Assistance to States for Capital Investment (SASCI), Hirakud and Satkosia to get around Rs 100 crore each for holistic development
- Around 4,780 acres of land identified for acquisition for private sector investment for development of Hospitality Districts/Hubs across the state
- For the first time, Odisha hosted the Pravasi Bharatiya Diwas on 8-10 January this year, where eminent dignitaries and industry leaders were engaged in discussions on Odisha's tourism potential and investment opportunities
- At the "Utkarsh Odisha – Make in Odisha" conclave earlier this year, 121 investors expressed their intent to invest Rs 8,154 crore, creating 28,446 jobs in key districts like Koraput, Puri, Keonjhar, Ganjam and Khordha
- 69 projects with an investment of Rs 4,364 crore in tourism and hospitality sector have been approved through the single-window mechanism and around Rs 50 crore of CIS has been disbursed to eligible tourism projects.